KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4-5 · UNIT 1: FIRST STEPS · FLORIDA FOCUS · SCIENCE

Florida Ecosystems: River of Grass, Mangroves and Reefs

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Page 1 (Pre): What I Already Know

Do this before the lesson. Guessing is OK!

1. What do you already know about the Everglades, mangroves or coral reefs? Write at least two things.

2. Prediction: Heavy rain fills Lake Okeechobee. Where do you think that water goes next, and how fast does it move?

3. Draw a food chain you think could live in a Florida wetland. Label the producer and the consumers.

4. What is one question you wonder about Florida's wild places?

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POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Page 2 (Post): What I Learned

Do this after the lesson. Use evidence and your own words.

1. Explain sheet flow in your own words. Why does Everglades water move so slowly?

2. Draw and label an Everglades food web with at least one producer, two consumers and one decomposer.

3. Use the wading bird data: what happened to nests in years with heavy dry-season rain? Give numbers as evidence.

4. Cause and effect: if the mangroves along a coast are cut down, what could happen to young fish and to nearby homes?

★ **Challenge:** Design a fair test: How could you test whether mangrove roots slow down waves? Name what you would change, what you would measure, and what you would keep the same.

Looking Ahead: Unit 2 explores how wind, water and weather shape the land. Bring this question: How might a hurricane's storm surge change a Florida shoreline?